

A photo is not text. So how can you copy it?

Your phone turns a picture of words
into words you can select and paste.

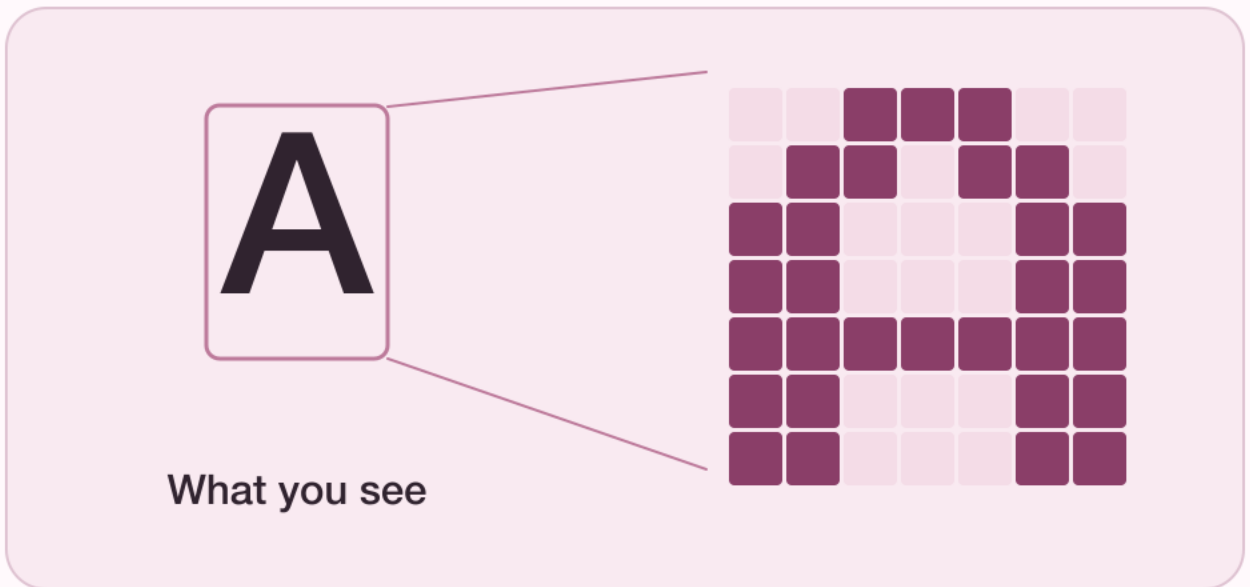


The AI finds and reads text inside the image.

The picture starts as tiny coloured squares.

Those squares are pixels.

The image does not contain typed letters.

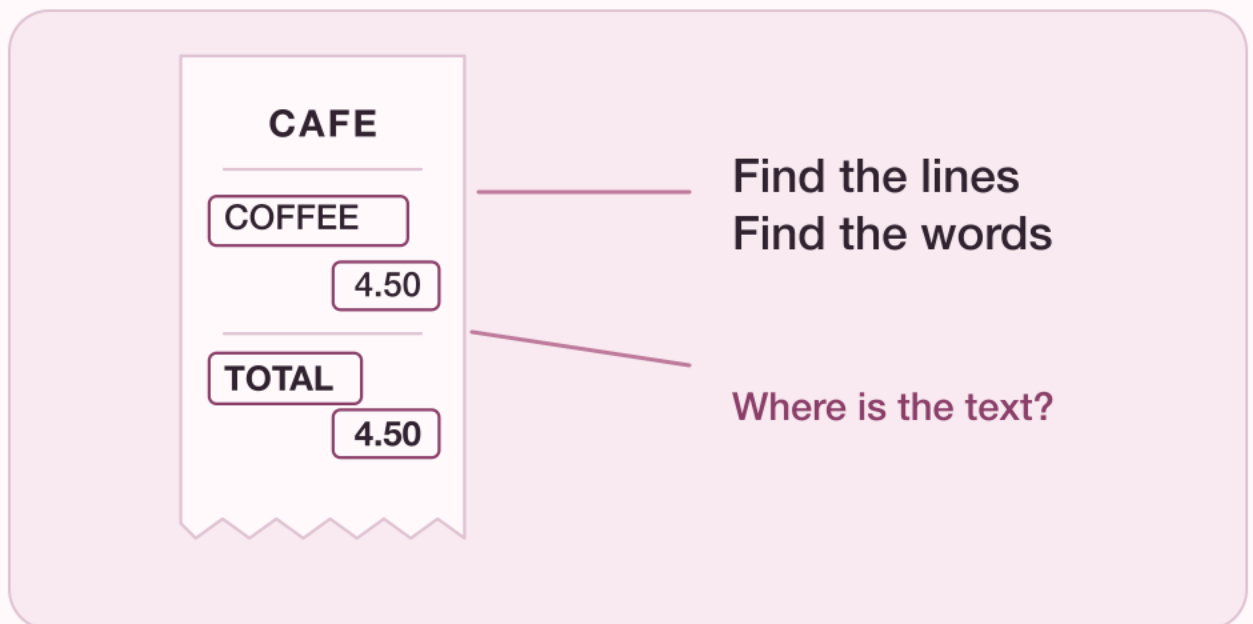


For the computer, this begins as image data.

The letter has not been typed into a text box.

First: find where the text is.

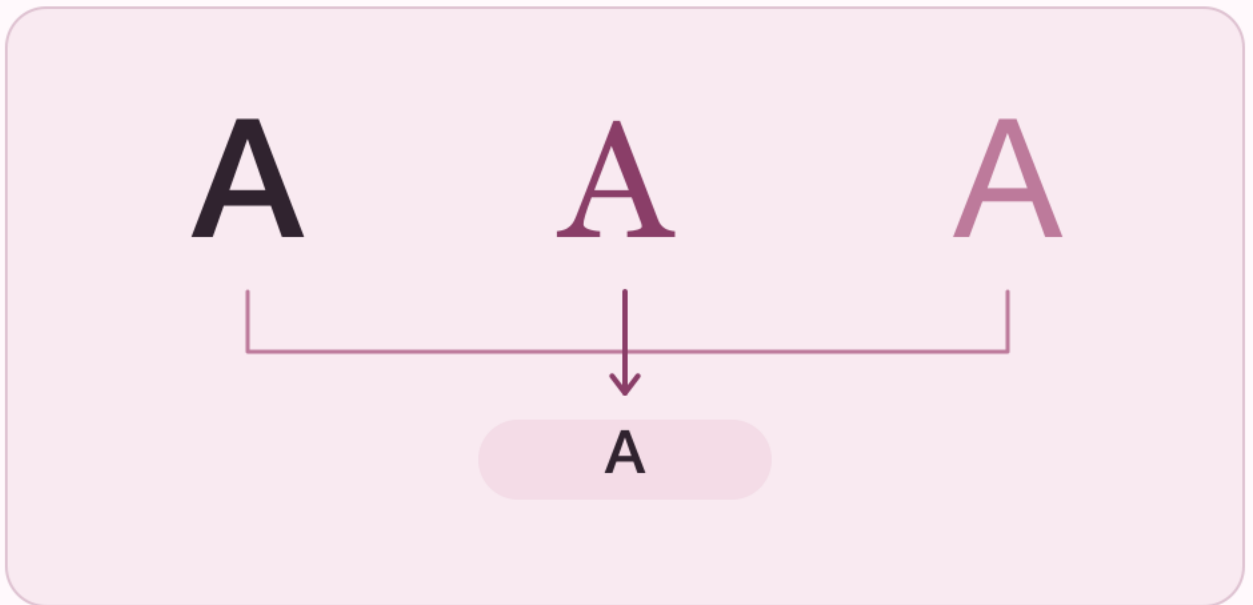
The system locates text regions, including lines and words.



Boxes show the regions the app can recognise.

Next: recognise the visible patterns.

Modern text recognition uses trained machine-learning models to read text.
Different shapes can represent the same letter.

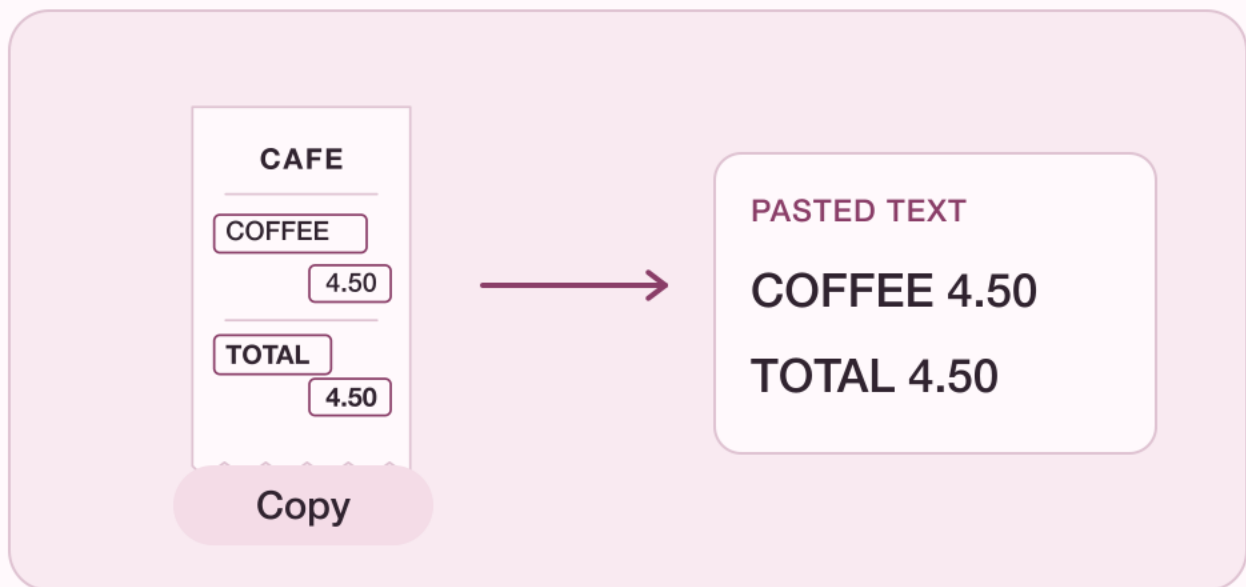


The model learns visual patterns from examples.
This diagram simplifies the recognition step.

Now the app has actual characters.

It returns text, not just a picture.

That is what you select, copy and paste.



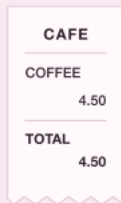
The app can now treat the result as text.

This is called OCR.

O C R

Optical character recognition.

In plain English: reading text from an image.

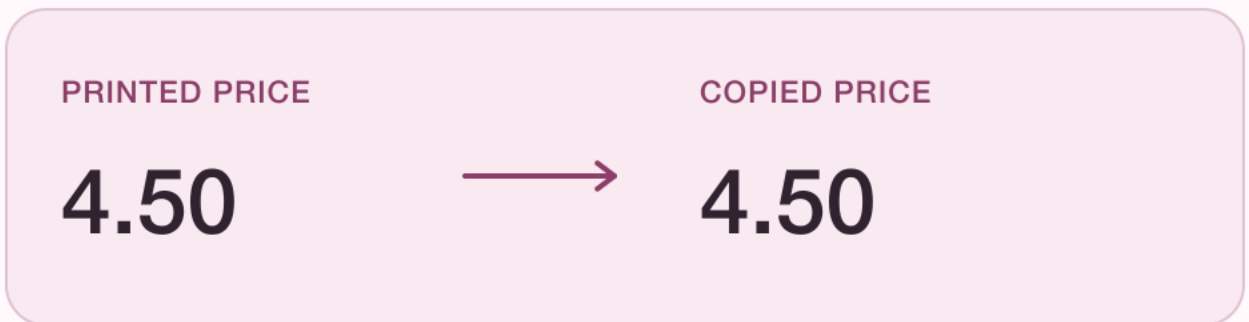


Copyable text

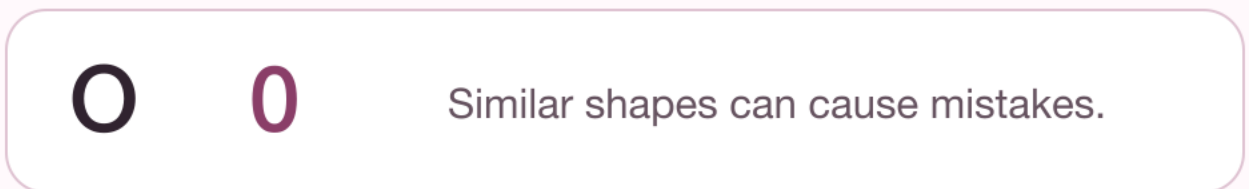
A different task from writing a chatbot answer.

Recognising a number does not check it.

The app can copy a wrong price correctly.
It can also misread the printed text.



Perfectly copied. The price could still be wrong.



Recognition is not the same as validation.

Does it need the internet?

Some tools read text on your phone.
Other apps send images to a server.
Check the app before scanning private documents.



On your phone



On a server

Where it happens depends on the tool or app.
A model download is different from uploading a photo.

Give it a clearer picture to read.



Hold still.

Use good light.

Get closer.

Then check names and numbers.

Compare the result with the original image.

Small text and blur can reduce accuracy.

Supported languages and features vary by tool.

Pixels become copyable words.

01 Find the text.

02 Recognise the patterns.

03 Return the characters.

Useful AI, doing one specific job.

The next time you copy a word from a photo, you know what changed: pixels became text.